

Recovering After Mistakes

DURATION	35–40 min · Unit 2 Week 4 (after Lesson 3, before Lesson 4)
OBJECTIVE	Students map a recent mistake through the four-phase recovery sequence — Activated → Regulating → Reflecting → Reintegrating — and articulate why regulation must precede repair and accountability work.
CASEL FOCUS	Self-Management: emotional regulation after mistakes · Self-Awareness: recognizing recovery phases · Responsible Decision-Making: sequencing repair correctly
NEW ANCHOR CHART	The Recovery Arc (ARC-1) — four-phase diagram. Must be posted before class begins.
WORKSHEET	WS-R2: My Recovery Map — private, completed in class, kept by student all year.
VOCABULARY	recovery, activated, regulating, reflecting, reintegrating, phase, sequence, window of tolerance

PLACEMENT NOTE

This lesson lands between Unit 2 Lesson 3 (Accountability Without Self-Punishment) and Lesson 4 (Talking to Yourself Kindly — the self-compassion letter). The Three-Part Accountability Map from L3 gives students a framework for what to do after a mistake. This strand lesson answers the question that precedes it: before you can use that map well, you need to be in a regulated enough state to use it at all.

SAFETY NOTE

Standard risk lesson — no counselor co-facilitation required. However, the private journal phase (WS-R2) invites students to apply the four phases to a real recent mistake. The worksheet is always private and never collected. If a student's journal writing during Step 3 triggers a disclosure, follow the standard disclosure protocol (Section 4 — Legal & Clinical Compliance).

OPENING REVIEW

2 Minutes

Point to the Window of Tolerance anchor chart (WOT-1). Hold up WS-R1 (My Toolkit) if students have theirs. “Last time in our strand work we built our toolkits. We learned that you cannot do hard emotional work from outside your Window. Today we go one step further: what does it actually look like to move from the moment a mistake happens — that hit of activation, shame, or dread — all the way through to being ready to do something real about it? That sequence has four phases. And knowing them changes how you treat yourself in the middle of them.”